

Parent's Guide to College Golf Recruiting

What You Need to Know to Help Your Child Succeed

Introduction

As a parent, you play a crucial role in your child's recruiting journey. This guide helps you understand the process, avoid common mistakes, and support your child effectively.

Your Role: Support, Not Drive

DO: Help with logistics (travel, registration, deadlines). Provide emotional support. Help research colleges. Be a sounding board.

DON'T: Email or call coaches on your child's behalf. Pressure them to commit early. Compare them to other recruits.

Coaches want to recruit the student-athlete, not the parent.

The Recruiting Timeline (Parent Edition)

Freshman (9th): Focus on skill development. Keep grades up. Don't worry about recruiting yet.

Sophomore (10th): Research colleges. Create a tournament budget. Register a free NCAA Eligibility Center account.

Junior (11th) — Critical Year: Build target school list. Support child in emailing coaches. Plan campus visits. Complete paid NCAA registration.

Senior (12th): Compare scholarship offers. Support the final decision. Celebrate the commitment.

Common Parent Mistakes to Avoid

1. Starting too late — many spots are filled by junior year.
2. Only looking at D1 — 1,700+ programs across D2, D3, NAIA, JUCO.
3. Overvaluing one tournament — coaches look at consistency.
4. Ignoring academics — often 50%+ of the recruiting equation.
5. Letting your child do it alone — they need help with logistics and support.

Understanding Scholarships

Golf is an equivalency sport. Most scholarships are PARTIAL.

D1 Men: 4.5 / team D1 Women: 6 / team

D2 Men: 3.6 / team D2 Women: 5.4 / team

D3: no athletic scholarships (but generous academic aid).

Financial Planning

Annual Junior Golf Costs (Estimate):

Tournaments: \$4,000–\$8,000

Travel: \$5,000–\$15,000

Coaching: \$3,000–\$10,000

Equipment: \$1,500–\$3,000

Total: \$13,500–\$36,000 per year

How we help: strategic tournament selection, recruiting roadmap, scholarship negotiation.

Questions to Ask Coaches (For Parents)

- ☐ What is the team culture like?
- ☐ How do you handle injuries?
- ☐ What academic support is available?
- ☐ What does a typical weekly schedule look like?
- ☐ How much travel is involved?
- ☐ Where do most players live?
- ☐ What is the retention rate for freshmen?

Signs Your Child Is Being Recruited

- ☐ Coach responds to emails quickly
- ☐ Coach asks for tournament schedule
- ☐ Coach attends your child's events
- ☐ Coach calls or texts directly
- ☐ Coach offers an unofficial or official visit
- ☐ Coach asks about academics

When to Get Help

Consider professional guidance if you feel lost, your child isn't getting coach responses, you're behind schedule, you want to maximize scholarships, or you need a clear plan.

Next Steps

1. Download our Recruiting Timeline.
2. Review the NCAA Eligibility Checklist.
3. Book a free strategy call.

You don't have to navigate this alone.

For more recruiting resources, visit www.cfa.golf